capabilities of the Indian armed forces. It was the largest mobilization of Indian forces on the Indian subcontinent, involving the combined strength of two Army commands. More than half a million men comprising ten Divisions and three Brigades were involved, more than any NATO exercise or national exercise since World War II.[3] This obviously sent alarm bells ringing in Pakistan, who, fearing a blitzkrieg-type attack to dismember them, mobilized their own army. As part of the operational plans, it was also decided to mobilize the Dual Task Formations (DTF), those Divisions having a primary role in the Eastern theatre and a secondary role in the West. Exactly the opposite had been done in the 1971 war, when the DTF from the West had been moved to the East, so the Pakistanis were a worried lot. 20 Mountain Division was one of those DTFs.

Every unit has a mobilization scheme, a thick leather-bound book, which gives out in the minutest detail what actions are to be carried out, by whom and by when. The whole train of events is set in motion by issuing the codeword for mobilization, which is known to all. For our unit, that code word was Kxxxxh. As the Adjutant, it was my responsibility to monitor the entire mobilization, stepping in whenever required to coordinate. One of the first tasks was to summon the bugler to give out the special bugle call denoting an alert. These days, the same can probably be done through a single SMS on a common user group (CUG), but those were the days when even landline phones were scarce commodities. Within six hours, the advance party had been dispatched to God knows where and the rest of the Battalion, the main body, was to follow twenty-four hours later. I have never seen a Military Special train, known for its snail's pace, travel at such speed, with only two halts in the day. One in the morning to issue breakfast and

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